

Project Final Report Format

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Empowering and Nurturing Orphans

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Introduction:

1. Introducing Community Service Project:

- *Reason For choosing this orphanage:* The service project that we chose was "Empowering and nurturing the Orphanage". For this the destination that we chose was "Mohammadi Aghosh Foundation". This is present in Islamabad Ghauri town. The reason we chose this orphanage was that this was a local orphanage, and it would have less facilities compared to the other famous ones. We wanted to see how the local orphanage works and what challenges do they face.
- *Brief history of orphanage:* This orphanage has been working for a long time and it has multiple branches
- *Societal issues and gaps being addressed* Education inequality was a big concern as the orphans usually are not able to get good education due to their financial conditions. They are deprived of the necessities of the modern world. They don't know much about mobile phones and computers as they are not financially able to buy or access these gadgets. So, giving them exposure to these technologies was also necessary. Mental health is a very important issue in the orphans as they are mostly treated very badly, and they also have traumas in the past which we cannot even imagine so giving them emotional support is important. This includes that we make them feel included in society.

2. Purpose and Objectives:

The purpose and objective of our project was to empower the orphans and help them in ways we practically can. This included helping them with studies, providing them with basic accessories that they usually are deprived of due to their financial situation, providing them with emotional support and making them feel that they are part of the same society. Our society just says that they want to empower the orphans, yet no one really does anything about it as we lack implementation about what we say and want to do.

3. Need Assessment:

The orphans mostly are weak in their studies as well as their emotional wellbeing is also not well. So, we felt the need for this visit as the orphans are also part of society and they are also equally deserving of the facilities as we are. So, we felt the need to help those kids. We also discussed the points where the children were facing problems with the head of orphanage which were mainly about the basic needs. These include food, education and health because they didn't have enough funds compared to the children present there. People nowadays hesitate to give donations because many times they are fraud. But another thing is that the materialistic views have increased so much that the people have lessened their donations, which is having a very bad impact on the organizations that are sincerely working for good cause.

4. Significance:

The significance of this will be that the children will not feel that they are not part of society and when the people see us, the university students doing their best for the

underprivileged ones, the people will most likely take more part in the activities involved in helping those people as hesitation will be removed. The personal growth we expect is that the children will not feel inferior to anyone else, and their superior psychology will be improved. They will be motivated to achieve more in life and won't feel that they are not inferior and are also allowed to reach the heights of the sky irrespective of their past.

5. Alignment with SDGs

- *SDG 1 - No Poverty*: We are helping the underprivileged children and helping them in their financial situation.
- *SDG 4: Quality Education*: Our second point was quality education, and we will try our best to help them in their educational situation. In areas where they are weak, we helped them to understand those concepts.
- *SDG 3: Good Health and Well-Being*: We didn't buy them anything that could affect their health and well-being. This was the concern of the orphanage as well as ours. Mostly the volunteers tend to buy such stuff as it is cheap, but the effects are terrible.
- *SDG 10: Reduced Inequalities*: We reduced the inequalities as the orphans mostly feel due to their situation. We made them feel comfortable and we succeeded in this. The children were feeling good and were very comfortable with us. This reduced the feeling of inferiority in them.

For Project Description

1. Details of Activities Conducted:

1. Teaching:

One of our activities was teaching those children. We noticed that education was very diverse. Children in the same orphanage went to various schools and their level was very different. There were children in the 4th class who didn't know how to do additional and subtraction but were admitted to 4th because of their age. This was mainly because when they came to the orphanage they never went to school before. Who knows what the circumstances of those children were. On the other hand, there were children in 1st class, and they knew addition, subtraction and all the basic stuff very well. So, this was a difficult task due to the diversity of the children present.

2. Distributing Goody bags:

On our last visit we distributed goody bags to all the children. This would be a happy ending and would be a memorable event for both the children and us. This was not much but the main thing that matters is the feelings that are shared not the items as the materialistic values don't matter.

3. Renovation:

There were two rooms in the orphanage which were in very bad condition. The children used that room for sleeping so it was supposed to be in good condition. So, we decided to renovate them. Renovation was the main and most difficult task that we performed. In fact, this was the most hectic and time-consuming. This was because we were all inexperienced in this, so we had to spend extra time and effort. The color selected by us was Off-White, but the orphanage liked Salsa, so we selected that as their consent was of most importance.

4. *Drawing activities:*

Drawing activity was organized because it was necessary for their creativity as creativity is the most important thing in humans. If creativity is lost, then the essence of life is lost. In the age of schooling creativity should be very essential but unfortunately our school system doesn't allow us to do any kind of creative stuff. So, we tried to organize a drawing event to at least do what we could do for this creativity enhancement.

5. *Jackets:*

As the winters are approaching, winter clothes are very necessary. The orphanage requested from us that they needed winter clothes and tracksuits as they didn't have much. So, we bought almost 61 items which would fulfill the orphanages' requirements. It was successfully done in our budget as we bought all of them as a wholesale from a single shop.

2. *Tasks Performed:*

1. *Teaching:*

Tasks for this were to identify which group required more educational assistance. We had to assess their existing knowledge, understanding and educational level. After this we were able to target that area which really needs our help in academics. It was difficult to explain them as if they were weak in the basics of every subject.

2. *Distributing goody bags:*

For this we had to purchase the content which we wanted to give to the children. We had to decide what would be most suitable for the children and buy that for them. Assembling and packing for all children was done after buying relevant stuff. After all preparations we personally distributed the bags to the children.

3. *Renovation:*

First, we had to identify which rooms required renovation. We asked the staff about their preferences regarding the renovation. We selected the paint color with the consent of the orphanage and then bought all the relevant stuff related to this. Then we had to arrange painters which fit into our budget. The last task related to the renovation was to bring the paints and painter to the location and start the renovation.

4. *Drawing activities:*

For drawing we had to first set up the area. Arranging the requirements which were needed for drawing were arranged. All the children were given accessories for drawing and then they were guided about how to draw creatively. We had to Guide the children who were hesitant in showing their creativity.

5. *Providing jackets:*

Buying winter clothing was a task which required donations, so we had to collect the donations. First, we discussed with the staff their needs and what the children's requirements are. After this searching for a reasonable shop which gives us a lot of clothing in budget was the main task to be done. There were total of 61 Jackets bought. The last thing that was left was to transport them to the orphanage, which was a problem as there were a lot of bags and it was very difficult.

3. Research Methodologies

Primary Research:

- First, we finalized what we must do for the project.
- We searched for the orphanages in our vicinity.
- After this we found the most underdeveloped orphanage and volunteered there.

4. TimeLine:

- *First Week:* In the first week we visited the orphanage to confirm that we will work as a volunteer here.
- *Second & Third Week:* In the second week we started teaching the children as when we arrived, they were having an academy going on at that time.
- *Fourth Week:* In the fourth week, our target was shifted to the renovation and winter clothes, so we started doing preparation for them.
- *Fifth Week:* In Fifth week, we bought the winter clothes and requirements for the renovation.
- *Sixth week:* In Sixth week, we renovated the rooms and distributed the goody bags.

Ethical Considerations

2 Consent

We based our endeavour around a relationship of consent, trust, and respect. We tried to maintain a healthy and good environment by inculcating respect in all our interactions with the administration. We also interacted with the children with upmost care and empathy. All the work that we did was done with the consent of the wishes and the requirements of the administration and

the children. This was to ensure that their consent was present in every aspect of our activity.

We were careful with every resource, gift, and donation we gave to the orphanage.

All the volunteering we did was confirmed to be helpful first and then implemented.

- Participants understanding the purpose

The participants were clearly explain about the whole ordeal. We took many sessions and discussed this endeavor thoroughly amongst ourselves. After a long, careful and considerate thought process, we came to the conclusion that there were no harmful aspects associated with this activity. There were some challenges, sure, but they were minute and scarce to deter us from the benefit of the activity that we would undertake.

- Privacy

We also did our best to respect the privacy concerns of the orphanage. All of our activity was done in a separate area so that we would not disturb the regular lives of the children. Everywhere we went we asked for permission first, even though there were no women in the institution. In addition to physical privacy, we also made sure that we took care of institutional privacy. All the images that were taken of the children were shared with them as a measure of transparency and respect. No images were shared without their consent.

- ☐ Cultural sensitivity

Because of the nature of our activity, it was unrelated to politics, religion, or culture. The children acted like siblings and had no concern for caste, creed, race or religion. They were pretty chill and despite of their cultural differences, coexisted peacefully. Their differences seemed to disappear and fade away due to their shared struggle and circumstances. After noticing this, we concluded that bringing up cultural differences would be pointless and possibly harmful because it might unintentionally draw attention to divisions that the kids themselves were unaware of. In the end we decided that it was not worth it to discuss this issue as we decided not to plant a seed of discontent between them. We also urged them to care for each other and not fight with each other.

?? how you considered the cultural sensitivity? it was asked

▣ Dilemmas and challenges

There were two issues in the orphanage: one was the issue was hygiene and cleanliness and the other was mental health and relaxation issues.

The children did not get enough rest and relaxation. Most of their time was spent in studying and schooling. This was negative for their development and personality grooming. All week they studied and then on Saturday, they had time to rest and play. The next issue was the dingy and poor conditions of the institution. This was bad for their physical health. The entire place was moldy and smelled foul. The walls had chipped away and were soggy. There were multiple areas where mosquitos and insects were dense, and one child even got dengue.

We urged the institution to clear up these issues. Regarding the first issue, we urged that the children should have 1 hour of sleep in the evening and 1 hour of television at night every day. This would help them relax and be at ease. Secondly, we arranged for a painter to paint and renovate the walls. Moreover, we urged the administration to clean the institution as there were multiple health hazards. These were the only issues we found there, and the administration tried their best to fulfil these concerns.

▣ Conflicts of interest

The only small conflict of interest we had while volunteering at the orphanage was when we proposed taking the children to a local park for some playtime and relaxation. We thought this kind of outing would allow the kids to chill and have fun, providing some deserved relief and temporary freedom from their tough academic schedule. The administration was enthusiastic and hasty regarding our suggestion since they valued the children's education and thought that any deterrent from their set schedule would harm their academic life. We really didn't resonate with this logic as we had been students ourselves.

But still we acknowledged their viewpoint and respectfully argued for the value of letting kids relax and take part in unrestrained play. This disagreement shrunk and the issue was resolved by the administration when they promised us that they would revise their academic schedule and include some playtime for the children so that they had time to be kids, right after their exams ended. No more arguments surfaced. Aside from this minor incident, our interaction with the administration went smoothly, and both sides contributed to improving the benefit of the kids.

▣ Guidelines and ethical standards

Our volunteer program was completely autonomous and unaffiliated with any outside organization or non-governmental organizations. Because of this independence, we were able to make our own rules and standards so that we could set our project in accordance with the benefits of the children and the institution. We oversaw planning, carrying out, and supervising every aspect of the project since we were the ones who made every single decision.

At the same time, we dealt with the orphanage's management in a kind and competent manner. We acknowledged their authority and tried to work together in a manner that created a sense of respect that we wanted to maintain throughout our endeavor. Throughout our time at the foundation, maintaining a good and easy-going relationship with the administration required maintaining a balance between being friendly to the kids and showing respect for them.

Results

After providing our services at an orphanage, there were several outcomes that we are going to discuss.

- First, the personal experience and skills that we gained from providing our services by conducting studying activities as well as extracurricular activities for the orphans.
- We developed deeper understanding of social issues and how to address them.
- Equipped children with skills of conceptual learning and avoiding rote learning.
- Made children understand the importance of utilizing free time effectively and utilizing it in their hobbies or exploring their hidden talent.
- Organization realized the importance of students' balancing academic life along with social life.
- By fundraising, we tried our best to foster a sense of community and awareness among the people that orphans are also a part of our community who need our special attention and love.
- People became aware of the challenges that orphans face in our society.

Impacts

1. Major Impact

Everyone participating benefited from the project's positive influence on the neighborhood. The main beneficiaries were orphans, who received care and opportunities for a better future as well as improvements in their living situations, education, and physical and mental health.

Administrators also got relief because the project reduced their workload by providing some helpful assistance and optimizing their activities.

Through their donations, donors experienced emotional and spiritual fulfillment that strengthened their sense of belonging to the community and their ability to positively impact the world. Project participants had the opportunity to develop both personally and professionally, and their efforts gave them a sense of purpose and appreciation.

All things considered, the project improved lives, created a sense of communal support, and united different groups.

2. Tangible or intangible benefits

Our project aimed to help the orphans as much as possible in our power. There were several tangible advantages. We hired painters and bought paint to clean and repaint the walls so that the children could feel at ease in their rooms. We also provided them with academic support and assistance so that they could have ease in developing their skills. The orphanage's financial assistance also helped it maintain its academic endeavors and everything. Together, these activities greatly raised the orphans' standard of living and displayed the commitment and effort that our group made to help these individuals.

3. Relation with SDGs

Several SDGs were considered and worked on.

By giving the institution financial support through donations, we did our best to combat poverty. Additionally, we offered the kids direction and a basic understanding of money as financial education.

Additionally, we tried to clean and enhance the poor and unhygienic circumstances that were there. We tried our best to persuade the institution of the issues with cleanliness and good hygiene so that the children experienced healthy childhoods.

We couldn't provide them with a high-quality education in the time we had available. However, we made every effort to educate them and inform them of the different opportunities that are available.

The study focused on orphans, a particularly vulnerable group of people. We did this so that we could remove the inequities that persisted in society. By providing financial, educational, and emotional support, the project helped give these children the opportunity to try to improve their circumstances.

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Discussion

1. Group Experiences

As a group, we did not only complete the tasks but instead we also had a lot of fun and had a great time going to the orphanage and spending time with children. For the first time, we all used to spend time travelling after university hours. When we reached an orphanage, we used to forget all our worries and just focus on the betterment of the children. Their smiles and love towards us will always be unforgettable. But in this journey, we also faced a lot of issues which we also figured out as well.

2. Challenges Encountered

First, finding the organization seemed a little hectic as we had to go everywhere as a group, and it was difficult as our academic routine was very strict. We visited many organizations in order to provide our social services, but we got rejected as they were not catering for volunteers any more for their project. Apart from that we noticed rude behavior from a head of SOS Village (one of the organizations we visited). Finally, we found a suitable organization "MUHAMMADI AGHOSH" who were looking for volunteers to address their organizational as well as children needs.

Further, when we started working at the orphanage, there were many challenges that we faced and addressed effectively. The challenges are discussed as follows:

- We came to know that there is no playtime of the children except for Sundays and they just study from morning till evening 6 days of the week.
- Students did not have playing equipment or enough stationery that they can do arts with or play in their free time.
- Due to lack of material, it was difficult to conduct arts activities and teaching workshops.
- The renovation process seemed difficult for us as it was our first time doing social work and we did not have any prior experience of painting walls and its whole process.
- Raising funds for the renovation process was difficult as most people were unwilling to donate.
- Choosing painters for painting was difficult as our budget was very low and painters demand was very high.
- The few challenges we faced ourselves were travelling and managing budget and time.

We addressed these challenges as follows:

- We conducted drawing activity for some fun time of the students. The other team visiting there conducted playing activity for them.
- We gave children goody bags containing stationery and colors on our last visit.
- During drawing activity, we distributed pencils and colors among students taken from the orphanage central stationery materials by the permission of head.
- We were guided by our known ones and supported by our relatives as well. One of our team members' relatives showed interest in helping as they owned a paint shop.
- We tried our best sharing posters on social media and in our relatives and people donated.
- We finally found a suitable painter under our budget through our connections.
- We mutually collaborated and divided our expenses and also took some time out for the weekly tasks.

3. Lesson Learnt & Skills Gained

These challenges made us learn many lessons and skills. A very important skill that we gained from this social work is how to effectively communicate with others and deliver

your message. Apart from that, we gained management skills and learned how to manage a specific project successfully from start till end, managing budget and dealing with the personnel involved. While gaining these skills we also learnt a lot of lessons. One of which is to always remain happy no matter what. As we see those kids happy in their home, it was a wholesome moment. No matter if they are kids, but they gave us many reasons for living life.

4. Effectiveness of Group

Our project successfully met its objectives set at the start of this social work. We wanted to do social work by keeping in view the interest of both organization and the people for whom we are working. Our work successfully considered the needs of both and addressed them. While respecting the organizational rules and regulations, we guided students towards a path of good learning and nurtured them and worked for their better living conditions and standards. In conclusion, the project fulfilled its objectives successfully.

Recommendation

Based on the insights gained during our community service project at the orphanage, several recommendations can be proposed to enhance the impact of similar initiatives in the future:

1. Recommendations

- **Improved Resource Allocation:**

While our fundraising efforts were successful, future projects could benefit from a more structured approach to identifying specific needs of the orphanage, which we observed they lack. They purely lack the sports facilities, which is a very essential part of their needs. They should be provided with sports facilities, so they are able to exercise, which is beneficial to their health.

- **Reserved Time for Activities:**

On analysis of their schedule, we observed that they have a very hectic schedule. They attend the school in the morning, attend tuition classes after school and after that they have their Quran classes, which bring them to the end of the day. So, in my opinion, every human, either an adult or a child, needs some rest time in which they could rest, talk, play or anything else other than studying. So, their schedule should be organized in such a way that they have their free time to exercise their bodies or give it some rest.

2. Suggestions

- ***Improving the Educational System:***

As there are number of children of different ages, their academic distribution is disturbed. Meanwhile some children are performing well in their academics, some children lack some educational skills according to their age. So, they should be given extra tuition, so they catch up with other children of their age.

- ***Hiring Extra Teachers:***

One of the major problems we observed was that some children weren't getting enough tutoring attention, which led to their academic downfall. There are a total or more than 50 children in the orphanage house, and only one teacher is tutoring them in their tuition time. This causes a lack of attention for those who are academically left behind. So, some other teachers should be provided who can help managing teaching all students efficiently.

- ***Activities Based on Interests:***

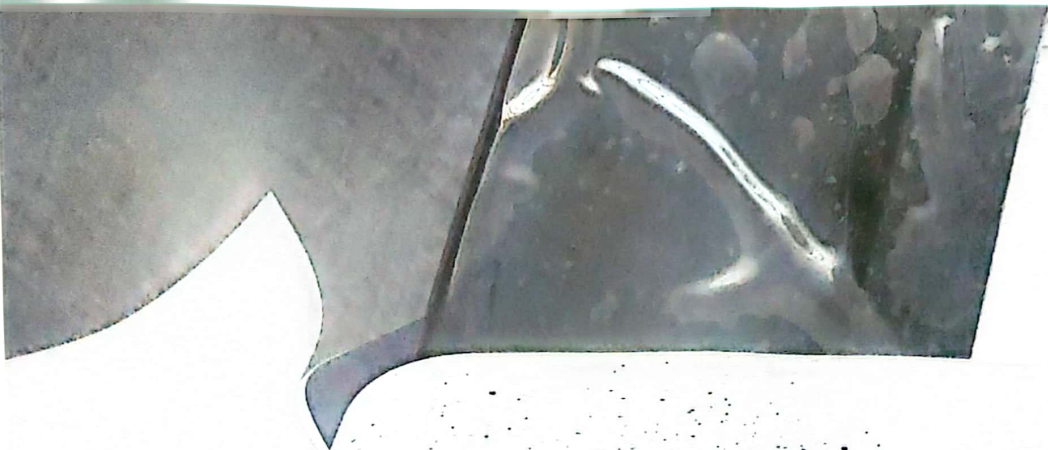
On the day we conducted some entertaining activities, which included drawing and sketching, the children were very much interested in such activities. Most of them told us that they have a high desire to do painting and drawing, but unfortunately, they lack the resources for such activities. So, they should be provided with the required resources so they can spend their leisure time on such activities, which would eventually turn into their hobby.

- ***Emotional Support:***

During our visits to the orphanage house, we observed that on each visit, their faces light up with pure joy when they see us. This means the affection we showed meant a lot to them and they may lack love and affection from the members of the organization. So, the members of the organization should be convinced to treat the children with pure affection. On the other hand, groups of students should keep visiting them to prevent them feeling deprived of emotional support.

Conclusion

Our community service project at the orphanage successfully achieved its primary objectives of empowering the children through education, engaging them in entertaining activities, and raising funds to support their daily needs. Through the interactive sessions, we were able to



strengthen the weak areas in the academic backgrounds of some children and provide them with additional knowledge. The activities organized promoted creativity, joy, and teamwork among the children, further enhancing their learning experiences. Finally, the renovation of their rooms and the winter clothes provided through our fundraising efforts will help improve their quality of life soon.

Overall, the project not only improved the children's lives but also taught us important lessons about responsibility, compassion, and teamwork. This experience emphasized the significance of addressing the needs of neglected regions of society and highlighted the necessity of education as a developing tool for sustainable community growth.

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